

Principles of Microeconomics

ECON 1101

Course Info _____

-  M & W 1:15 - 2:40 pm
-  Roux - 207

Instructor Info _____

-  **Seeun Park**
(pronounced SEH-n; she/her)
-  Student Hrs:
M, W 3 - 4:30 pm (drop-in)
R (by appointment)
-  Hubbard Hall - 113
-  s.park@bowdoin.edu

Learning Assistant _____

-  **Jack Fletcher**
(he/his)
-  LA Hrs:
Sun 7:30 – 9:00 pm
-  Roux 207
-  jfletcher@bowdoin.edu

1 Overview

Economics is the study of how individuals, businesses, and governments make choices about allocating limited resources to achieve their goals. In this course, we focus on the behavior and decision-making of economic agents, such as consumers and firms, using theories of demand, supply, cost, and market structures. You will apply economic principles covered in the class to real-world problems, which will help you develop a deeper understanding of the world.

2 Learning Objectives

By the end of the course, you should be able to:

1. **Identify** introductory microeconomic topics and concepts related to supply and demand, producer and consumer choice, and how the market works in today's society.
2. **Describe** economic concepts in your own words using relevant real-world examples
3. **Use graphs and basic math/formulas to explain** the discussed economic ideas
4. **Analyze** and **evaluate** real-world situations using course concepts
5. **Create** original explanations of discussed economic concepts using real-world examples and creative formats

3 Course Materials and Devices

- **Interactive Notes:** Interactive Notes are templates with key concepts, examples, and exercises to help you engage with the material. Download them from Canvas to use on a tablet or print them out.
- **Textbook:** The textbook is *Principles of Microeconomics* (3rd ed.) by OpenStax. A PDF is available on Canvas.
- **Other Materials:** Other additional required or optional readings and media materials will be available on Canvas.
- **Canvas:** Canvas will be the course hub for announcements, materials, assignments, feedback, and other resources. Check it regularly and turn on notifications to stay updated.
- **Gradescope:** You will submit your Problem Sets on Gradescope. A link to submit your work on Gradescope will be posted on Canvas.
- **Poll Everywhere:** Poll Everywhere will be used for real-time engagement and feedback during lectures. Registration instructions are on Canvas.

4 Grading Scheme

Here's how your grade will be determined, with each assessment weighted as follows:

28%	Problem Sets (7 sets, 4% each)
54%	Exams (3 exams, 16%, 18%, and 20% each)
18%	Project (15% written analysis, 3% peer review)

Final course grades are based on the weighted average of all course components. There is no fixed curve that limits how many students can earn each grade. While not guaranteed, students with averages in the 60s may be considered for a passing grade (C range) at the instructor's discretion.

Grades follow the standard scale:

A	[95.00,100]	A–	[90.00,94.99]		
B+	[87.00,89.99]	B	[83.00,86.99]	B–	[80.00,82.99]
C+	[70.00,79.99]	C	[65.00,69.99]	C–	[60.00,64.99]
D	[50.00,59.99]	F	<50		

Final scores within 0.20 percentage points of a grade cutoff (e.g., 94.80%) may be rounded at the instructor's discretion, taking attendance and participation into account.

4.1 Problem Sets

Problem sets (PS) provide an excellent opportunity to apply economic concepts to analyze and evaluate real-world problems using graphs, equations, and models. While most questions will focus on the current week's material, some may also review concepts from previous weeks.

- Problem sets will be posted on **Monday after 5 PM** and are **due the following Monday at 1 PM**.
- **Late work** will be accepted for up to one week after the original deadline with a 20% deduction. After the answer keys are posted (1 PM on the Monday following the original deadline), no late submissions will be accepted.
- **Out of a total of 9** problem sets, the lowest 2 will be dropped.
- When working in groups, submit your own work (see Group Work).
- Problem Sets **must be submitted on Gradescope**, not Canvas.
- Using generative AI, such as ChatGPT, is not permitted (see Academic Integrity).
- *It is your responsibility to check that your problem set is correctly uploaded.* Any corrected upload after the deadline, or any failure to upload on time, will be treated as late or missing under the due date policy described above.

4.2 Exams

There will be three exams in this course:

Exam	Date	Time	Material Covered
Exam 1 (16%)	Mon, Feb 23	During Class Time	Modules 2–5
Exam 2 (18%)	Wed, Apr 1	During Class Time	Modules 6–9
Exam 3 (20%)	Thu, May 14	1:30 – 4:30 PM Roux 207	Modules 10-14

Each Exams will focus on the modules listed above, but key concepts from earlier course material may also appear. Additional details about exam format and policies will be announced before each exam.

4.3 Project: “ECON-IN-THE-WILD”

Throughout the semester, I will share real-world examples with you. For this project, you'll find your own example from the world (“wild”) and share it with your classmates. For more details, please refer to the separate project document.

Version	Deadline*	Notes
Draft**	Tue, April 15	Submit to receive feedback (optional).
First	Mon, April 20	Must be on time (20% late penalty, 9-hour grace period).
	Wed, April 22	In-class Peer Review
Final	Sun, May 10	Optional revision; if not submitted, first version is final.

* All deadlines are 11:59 PM ET.

** *Whenever you're ready, feel free to discuss your ideas with the instructor, even before April 15.*

5 Group Work

This course is designed around in-class group activities, with much of our second weekly meeting devoted to collaborative problem-solving. You are welcome to work with others on problem sets outside of class as well, but you must **submit your own work** and **list the names of your group members** on your submission. A helpful way to approach problem sets is:

- Review the notes.
- Attempt all practice questions on your own.
- Meet with your group to discuss the problem set.
- Write up and submit your own answers after the discussion.

6 Attendance

Because this course relies heavily on in-class group activities, attendance is expected. I do not formally take attendance, but attendance may be considered when determining final grades that fall on the borderline between two grades. If you are unable to attend class, please send me a brief email.

7 Late Work Policy

7.1 Make-up Exams

Make-up exams will only be allowed with **prior approval** (for scheduled conflicts such as religious observance or university-approved activities) or in cases of **documented emergencies** (such as illness, accident, or family emergency). Documentation must be provided as soon as possible.

Make-up exams will cover the same material but **may differ in format or include slightly modified questions or numbers**. This ensures fairness while helping maintain academic integrity. Students are expected to take the make-up exam as soon as possible following the missed exam.

Because the date of **Exam 3** is announced on the first day of the semester, please **plan travel accordingly**. Exceptions require approval from the student's Dean.

7.2 Late Problem Sets Submission

Since the lowest two problem sets (PS) are dropped, no make-ups are allowed. You may either skip a week (no explanation needed) or submit late with a penalty (see Grading Scheme). Any work submitted after the answer key is posted or without prior notification will receive a zero.

Q: I have already missed two (2) PS but now have to miss another due to an emergency.

A: You may submit late without penalty for acceptable reasons (e.g., documented sports events, illness, or family emergencies) if you notify me before the original deadline.

7.3 Late Project Submission

Because the project is tied to in-class activities, the first version is due on **April 20**. A 9-hour grace period is allowed. Submissions after that lose 20% if turned in before class on April 22, and 50% if later. (See Project Deadlines)

7.4 Extra Credit

To keep grading fair and consistent, no extra credit will be offered in this course.

8 Academic Integrity

Academic integrity means **doing your own work honestly** and giving proper credit when you use others' ideas. You can read more about Bowdoin's Academic Honor Code and related policies on Canvas.

8.1 Uses of Generative AI

Generative AI can be useful, but this course emphasizes learning by working through problems yourself. Please do not use AI to solve problem sets or complete projects. If you need help or clarification, use human resources such as the instructor, the learning assistant, or your peers.

Limited use of AI is appropriate for:

- Grammar or style checks
- Citation formatting

If you are unsure whether a use is appropriate, feel free to ask me.

9 Tips for Success in this Class

1. **Attend class:** Annotated notes will be posted, but being present makes the material clearer and easier.
2. **Ask questions:** whether in class, during Student Hours, or by email.
3. **Stay engaged:** Active participation reinforces learning.
4. **Check Canvas and email regularly:** Stay up to date and avoid missing important announcements or materials.
5. **Review notes daily:** Revisiting notes each day helps solidify your understanding.
6. **Understand the material before practicing:** Practice is most effective once the concepts are clear.
7. **Work on problem sets independently:** Try them on your own first, then discuss with others or ask me or the LA for help. On exams, you'll be on your own.
8. **Talk to me if something is unclear:** Reach out anytime. I'm here to help.

10 Communication

10.1 Canvas

Course announcements will be posted on **Canvas**. Please turn on notifications (*do this now!*).

10.2 Student Hours

The best way to get support is during Student Hours, which are dedicated to helping you with this course. I strongly encourage you to stop by my office (one of the best offices in Hubbard!). If Student Hours don't fit your schedule, email me to set up an appointment.

10.3 Email

I aim to respond within 24 hours, though messages sent after 6 PM may be answered the next day. **When emailing me**, include **[Econ 1101]** in the subject line (e.g., [Econ 1101] Extra Student Hour).

11 Student Support Resources

11.1 Accommodations

You may need accommodations for different reasons, such as a documented disability or observing a major religious holiday.

- **Disability accommodations:**
 - Register with the **Student Accessibility Office**.
 - Once approved, please meet with me within the first 2 weeks of class (or as soon as you become aware of your needs) to ensure they are implemented.
- **Religious observances:** You may make up coursework missed due to observing a major religious holiday, provided you make arrangements with me in advance and notify me within the first 2 weeks of class.

11.2 Academic, Personal, and College Support

Bowdoin provides many resources to support your success, well-being, and sense of belonging in this course and beyond.

- **Baldwin Center for Learning and Teaching (BCLT):** Peer tutoring, writing help, Q-Tutors for Math/Science/Stats/Econ, and academic mentoring.
- **Counseling Services:** Confidential mental health support and resources.
- **College Policies:** Bowdoin is committed to diversity, inclusion, and a safe learning environment. This includes policies related to Title IX and mandated reporting. Full details and resources are available on Canvas.

12 Class Schedule

Week	Date	Topic	PS (Posted)*	PS (Due)*	Chapter
1: How Markets Work					
1	Jan 21	Introduction: Course Overview & Module 1: Thinking Like an Economist			1.1-1.3
2	Jan 26	Module 2: Gains from Trade			2.2
	Jan 28	Module 2 (cont.)	PS 1		19.1-19.2
3	Feb 2	Module 3: Demand and Supply	PS 2	★PS 1	3.1-3.3
	Feb 4	Module 3 (cont.)			
4	Feb 9	Module 4: Elasticity	PS 3	★PS 2	5.1-5.2,5.4
	Feb 11	Module 4 (cont.)			
5	Feb 16	Module 5: Price Controls		★PS 3	
	Feb 18	<u>Review</u>	In-class	★PS 4	5.3
2: When Markets Don't Work					
6	Feb 23	Exam 1			
	Feb 25	Module 6: Market Outcome & Tax Incidence	PS 5		3.5
7	Mar 2	Module 7: Externalities			12.1-12.3, 13.1-13.3
	Mar 4	Modules 6 & 7 (cont.)			
8	Mar 9	<i>Spring Break</i>		★PS 5	
	Mar 11	<i>Spring Break</i>			

* **Problem Sets (PS)** will be posted by 5 PM and are due by 1 pm on the specified dates.

Week	Date	Topic	PS (Posted)*	PS (Due)*	Chapter
3: How Consumers and Firms Behave					
9	Mar 16	<i>Spring Break</i>			
	Mar 18	<i>Spring Break</i>			
10	Mar 23	Module 8 Consumer Choice	PS 6		6.1-6.2
	Mar 25	Module 9 Business Costs and Production			7.1-7.5
11	Mar 30	<u>Review</u>		★PS 6	
	Apr 1	Exam 2			
12	Apr 6	Module 10: Firms in a Competitive Market	PS 7		8.1-8.4
	Apr 8	Module 10 (cont.)			
13	Apr 13	Module 11: Monopoly	PS 8	★PS 7	9.1-9.2
	Apr 15	Module 11 (cont.)			
14	Apr 20	Module 12: Monopolistic Competition		★PS 8 Project V1 [†]	10.1
	Apr 22	“ECON-IN-THE-WILD” Peer Review			
15	Apr 27	Module 13: Oligopoly	PS9		10.2
	Apr 29	Module 13 (cont.)			
16	May 4	Module 14: Asymmetric Information		★PS 9	16.1-16.2
	May 6	<u>Review</u>			
	May 11	<i>Reading Period (May 7-10)</i>		Project V2 [‡]	
	May 14	Exam 3			

* **Problem Sets (PS)** are due by 1 pm on the specified dates.

[†] The **first version** of the project (**Project V1**) is due Monday, April 20 at 11:59 PM.

[‡] The **final version** of the project (**Project V2**) is due Sunday, May 10 at 11:59 PM

13 Important Dates

Date	Event
Tue, Feb 3	<i>Add/Drop ends at 5:00pm</i>
Mon, Feb 23	Exam 1 (in-class)
Wed, Mar 11	<i>Extended Course Drop ends</i>
Wed, Apr 1	Exam 2 (in-class)
Mon, Apr 20	Project V1 due (11:59 PM)
Wed, May 6	Last day to initiate the <i>Incomplete</i> for the course
Sun, May 10	Project V2 due (11:59 PM)
Thu, May 14	Exam 3 (1:30 – 4:30 PM, Hatch 214)